



AN ESTABLISHED SUPPORT NETWORK | EXERCISE 1

Building your Personal Network Map

Ask yourself: Do you have a strong network of people you can turn to?
Who do you turn to in any given situation?
Now map out your network with these simple steps:

1

Using a piece of paper or online application draw a circle in the middle. This is you!

2

You are now going to draw your network depicted as other circles. You may want to define your professional and personal networks separately or on the same map.

3

Now add people from your network to the map as follows:

- Place people whom you have a closer relationship nearer to you on the network map with the circle in a solid line.
- Place people whom you don't have a close relationship further away from you.
- Draw a bigger circle for people who have greater importance in your life.
- Colour code the different circles as follows to assess the quality of the relationship;
 - Blue: Mentor/coach
 - Green: Supporter
 - Orange: Neutral
 - Red: Negative/enemy
 - White: Unknown
- Add to each circle the person's name and role/what you need/get from them

4

Assess your network map and consider the following:

- What do you want from these individuals?
- What can you offer in return?
- Which relationships do you need to strengthen?
- Do you have all aspects of your professional and personal support covered or are there any gaps?
- If there are gaps, identify who could provide the support you are looking for in that area.

5

Build an action plan to broaden and deepen your relationships.



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Personal Network Map - Example

Larger circle =
more important
relationship

Closer to centre =
closer relationship



Best Practice - Defining Your Personal Network - Home & Work

- Identify the important relationships in your life – family, friends and colleagues.
- Consider the depth and closeness of these relationships.
- Do you have people you can turn to for help when things get tough?
- Create your personal network map and identify gaps and relationships you may need to work on.